What language should I learn first?

Start with the problem. Languages are choices, not rankings.

YOUR GOAL	POSSIBLE START
01 **Explore data / machine learning** — Data cleaning, experiments, databases	**Python, R, SQL**
02 **Build an interactive website** — Browser behavior, typed web apps	**JavaScript → TypeScript**
03 **Write scalable network services** — Services, concurrent requests, shared codebases	**Go, Java, C#**
04 **Work close to hardware** — Memory, performance, drivers, systems	**C, C++, Rust**
05 **Build mobile apps** — Apple and Android ecosystems	**Swift, Kotlin**
06 **Automate everyday tasks** — Files, processes, repetitive work	**Python, Bash**
07 **Create dynamic server pages** — Web backends and content sites	**PHP, JavaScript**

HTML (HyperText Markup Language) describes structure; CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) controls appearance; JavaScript programs behavior. SQL (Structured Query Language) asks for data; Bash orchestrates commands.

How the program runs	interpreter / compiler / runtime
How mistakes are caught	dynamic / static checking
Who manages memory	manual / managed / ownership
How code is organized	procedural / object / functional / declarative

A beginner-friendly guide, not a performance benchmark. The project and ecosystem often matter more than the syntax.

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